

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2019

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 8)

- 2 points for each correct answer; 1 with one error (e.g. one wrong morpheme).
 - + = morpheme boundary, included for marker's convenience – not expected in answers.

4.1.	chungpemyax	They were kissed.
4.2.	pichixgal	He used to die.
4.3.	We used to kill them.	pimi+chem+chix+nin+wen.
4.4.	You (plural) stepped on us.	chimi+wix+em+in



Commentary

- Verb templates
 - template 1 (with *in* or *yax*):
 - [obj] [ROOT] [subj] [in/yax] [“used to”]
 - template 2 (no *in/yax*):
 - [obj] [subj] [ROOT] [“used to”]
- Affixes:
 - no affix = intransitive
 - *in* = transitive (“i” drops after vowel: $V_{in} \rightarrow V_n$)
 - *yax* = passive
 - *nin* = causative (a kind of transitive, means “make X [verb]”)
 - “used to”: *qal* with singular subject, *wen* with plural subject
- Pronouns
 - Subject:

▪ 1s: ne	1p: chem
▪ 2s: e	2p: em
▪ 3s: pe	3p: pem
 - Object:

▪ 1s: ni	1p: chimi
▪ 2s: i	2p: imi
▪ 3s: pi	3p: pimi (in fact, it is <i>mi</i> , but <i>pimi</i> can be inferred)
- Verbs:
 - *wix* = step on
 - *pulin* = bear a child
 - *hama* = feel shame
 - *chung* = kiss
 - *chix* = die